

WORKING AND PLAYING IN THE METAVERSE

HOW WILL WE APPLY FOR JOBS IN THE METAVERSE,
HOW WILL WE PARTY?

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For a lot of us, still, our work lives, our social lives, and our online lives are different. They're managed differently, involve different people, and more importantly, different platforms. For example, your work might use more emails, and a bit of LinkedIn or Facebook. Your friends and family might interact more on Instagram or WhatsApp (Twitter and Telegram or Signal if you're untrusting of Meta Inc). And your escapism is done online via games, or on forums or whatever it is that you do in your free time. The aim now, for most metaverse companies, is to bring all of that into one single system. They want you to work, play and escape all using the same metaverse system and services. Mark Zuckerberg literally told you that when he announced the company's name change from Facebook Inc to Meta Inc.

So what will such a life look like, and will that be a good or bad thing? Do we care? Won't we just hop on to the bandwagon anyway? That's what we aim to find out in this article.

WORK

This one is easy. Most of us are used to working remotely thanks to the global pandemic, and that involves coordinating across distances, and using voice or video calls. With video calls it's a lot easier to see people and notice if they're paying attention in the meetings, though of course it's just as likely they're playing a game

on their screen, which is something you cannot see unless they share it. The VR metaverse, in that sense, would certainly take care of that, because we'd need to be wearing our



Source: Microsoft

headsets to see and hear what's happening in a meeting and thus would certainly be more 'present'.

It's going to go much further than simple meetings. All of the big money to be made in tech is in enterprise and business technologies. For a lot of us end-users Apple, Amazon, Google (Alphabet) and Facebook (Meta) dominate the headlines when it comes to big tech, but the second most valuable tech company on earth (behind Apple) is actually Microsoft. Why? Because it still owns huge market shares in enterprise and large business. A heck of a lot of things built by companies all across the planet rely on Microsoft's products to be able to do so. It's why Microsoft will certainly be a big player in the metaverse, and will certainly try and leverage their existing advantage of inroads with everything

work related to continue to rule this aspect of our lives.

Microsoft too, is betting on work meetings being the first point of entry into the metaverse for most people. It already announced Mesh for Microsoft Teams which it hopes will not only allow us to use Avatars to attend meetings and sit around round tables just as we like to do in the real world, but also included what it calls Holoportation – a virtual hologram to allow you to really feel like you're in the room with colleagues. Some fancy 360 degree camera hardware will no doubt be required, and they will push their own HoloLens VR hardware on people, but the final results seem exciting.

A simple advantage the metaverse has is that it's essentially unlimited in

terms of space. In our real lives we might have small and cramped work spaces, with colleagues sometimes rubbing shoulders with us, or we might have the exact opposite problem, and be in a branch office with colleagues who are in different cities or countries.

The metaverse solves this, because we all have the ability to be trillion dollar companies and have virtual workplaces that rival the real life Apple Park.

All of us can have luxurious bays, yet all close enough to talk to one another, and to be able to quickly gather and meet to discuss something important. We could have the freedom to not commute and work from home, whilst still being able to work together, in real-time. All of the problems of remote working, such as not being able to monitor employees, or feeling isolated and alone, can all be solved in the metaverse. Providing



Source: Microsoft